My (Chiffon) Nguyen

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Research Interests

Current and future AI that are socially responsible and beneficial for broader world: **AI alignment** (safety evaluation, pluralistic alignment, goal misgeneralization) and **AI control** (monitoring, scalable oversight); **multilingual and multicultural AI**; cooperative AI for **human-AI collaboration** and **multi-agent systems**.

Education

Minerva University, College of Computational Sciences Sep 2021 – May 2025

B.Sc in Computational Sciences (Machine Learning and Statistics), GPA: 3.7/4.0 *San Francisco, CA, USA*

- **Relevant Coursework**: Data Structures & Algorithms, Software Engineering, Machine Learning (A), Bayesian Modeling (A), Statistical Modeling and Causal Inference (A), Optimization Methods (A), Probability and Statistics (A-)
- **Global Experience**: Seoul (South Korea), Taipei, Hyderabad (India), Buenos Aires (Argentina), Berlin (Germany)

Selected Publication & Submissions

P=Preprint, **R**=Under Review, **J**=Journal, **C**=Conference, **W**=Workshop, *=Equal Contribution. Full list on Google Scholar.

[R2] **IncidentBench: Benchmarking AI Incident Prediction and Policy Recommendation**
Linh Le, Melanie Bui, **My Chiffon Nguyen**, Yosra Kazemi, Rishika Bansal, India Dearlove, Zachary Schlosser, and 4 others
Under review, 2026.

[R1] **CulturalRiddles: A Multicultural Benchmark of Riddles**
My Chiffon Nguyen*, Tianyi Hu*, Henry Gagnier*, Vinod Anbalagan*, Pouya Sadeghi*, and 149 others
EMNLP Workshop Multilingual Representation Learning (MRL); Under Review, 2026.

[C1] **SEATauBench: Progressively Adapting Tool-Agent-User Evaluation Into Low-Resource Southeast Asian Languages**
My Chiffon Nguyen*, Aulia Adila*, Saksorn Ruangtanusak*, Kittiphat Leesombatwathana*, Vissuta Gunawan Lim*, Patomporn Payoungkhamdee, Samuel Cahyawijaya
EMNLP Findings, 2026.

[W1] **Position: Synthetic Persona Needs Explicit Grounding and Standardized Reporting**
Yucheng Lu, Xiaoyi Liu, Heming Liu, Hanwen Xing, Shirley Huang, Guanghui Min, Zhengyang Shan, **My Chiffon Nguyen**, Ishan Gupta, Zonglin Di, Qianfeng Wen, Yifan Simon Liu, Ruoqi Gao, and 31 others
COLM Workshop Social Simulation with LLMs, 2026.

Research Experience

SPAR Research Mentee (AI Incident & Policy Simulation) Jul 2026 – Present

Supervised Program for Alignment Research (SPAR) Fall 2026 *Remote*

- Co-authoring **GPS-Bench** and **IncidentBench**, an evidence-grounded benchmark and simulation framework for evaluating AI-governance policy forecasts against historical records;
- Driving contributions on large-scale data collection, graph building, and writing
- Mentors: Dr. Linh Le (Lida Safety, Oxford Martin AIGI Affiliate) and Dr. David Williams-King (Lida Safety, ERA:AI)

Project Co-Lead (Multicultural Reasoning Evaluation) Apr 2026 – Oct 2026

Cohere Labs Community *Remote*

- Co-first authoring and co-leading **CulturalRiddles**, a culturally-grounded riddle benchmark spanning 62 cultures and 51 languages built through a 150+ people participatory community effort
- Led analyses of 170,772 model responses with human annotations and LLM judges and led manuscript writing
- Advisors: Dr Julia Kreutzer (Cohere Labs), Károly Boczka, and Prof Akhil Arora (Aarhus University)

SEACrowd Research Mentee (Multilingual Agent Benchmarking) Feb 2026 – Jun 2026

SEACrowd, SEACrowd 2026 Research Apprenticeship *Remote*

- Co-first authored **SEATauBench**, a benchmark evaluating tool-using conversational agents across four progressive language adaptation scenarios and five low-resource languages, by localizing Tau2-Bench; **EMNLP Findings 2026** [Code]
- Designed machine translation pipeline for agent-facing contexts while preserving executable and scoring layers, and ran an experiment (L2 Domain); conducted four-step review of translated trajectories, including managing human study for five language quality audits
- Analyzed 63000+ multi-turn agent-user-tool trajectories to diagnose performance degradation and language usage
- Mentors: Dr. Samuel Cahyawijaya (Cohere Labs) and Dr. Patomporn Payoungkhamdee (VISTEC)

AI Research Mentee (Chain-of-Thought Monitoring) Oct 2025 – Apr 2026

Algoverse AI Research, AI Research Program Fall 2025 (Mentor: Eyon Jang) *San Francisco, CA, US*

- Led a project on weak-to-strong chain-of-thought monitoring for detecting sandbagging–distinguishing deliberate underperformance from genuine incapability. [Code] [Draft]
- Designed a reproducible monitoring pipeline with Inspect AI and Inspect Scout; evaluated monitor success across 30+ pairs of reasoning models on CAIS's WMDP and BigCodeBench

Work Experience

Associate Researcher (AI Governance & Interpretability, Contract) Oct 2026 – Present
Lida Safety *Remote*

Research Engineer (AI Safety Evaluation, Contract) Jul 2026 – Present
Equistamp *Remote*

- Contributed to METR's Monitorability project by a providing human baseline in transcript analysis
- Maintaining inspect_evals with Generality Labs

AI Mentor (Contract) Dec 2025 – Jul 2026
Curious Cardinals *San Francisco, CA, US*

- Mentoring a high schooler on a research project on robustness of fact-checking language models under evidence corruption and language shifts, submitted to *ACL workshops
- Tutoring selected AI topics, from neural network fundamentals to neolab research trends

Teaching & Mentoring Experience

Minerva University, *PR51 Programming with Python*, Lead Tutor Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Taught 40+ first-year students from 20+ countries in **weekly hands-on programming labs** for 11 weeks, covering Python, OOP, debugging, security, and computing fundamentals
- Analyzed student performance data and tutor surveys across 11 weeks to identify 12 learning bottlenecks, improving engagement metrics by 15% for the next cohort
- Reviewed and gave feedback on **9 Python programming assignments** for 150+ students

Minerva University, *FA50/FA51 Logic, Probability & Statistics*, Lead Teaching Assistant Sep 2022 – Apr 2024

- Supported **150+ students** each semester in formal logic, probability and statistics, algorithmic thinking, and simulation, through **70+ weekly office hours**
- Provided **formative assessment on 25 semesterly quizzes** for 50 students to correct and shape their learning
- Assisted professors in **grading** three semesterly math and programming assignments

Selected Projects

MyScholar Astro Theme (github.com/mychiffonn/myscholar) Nov 2025 – Sep 2026

- Designed a theme for academic portfolios and labs in (Astro v7, TypeScript), with publication export, technical writing, and i18n

Multilingual Representations (labscommunity.cohere.com/blog/2026/inside-tiny-aya-what-an-sae-sees/) Mar 2026

- Investigated whether circuits in multilingual LLM like Tiny Aya are language-specific, script-specific, regional, or universal with Sparse Autoencoders (SAEs) [HuggingFace]
- Evaluated generation quality before and after feature steering across 67 languages using LaBSE semantic similarity, script conformity, and LLM-as-a-judge, comparing with Flores-200 and CulturaX datasets

Technical Skills

- **Programming Languages**: Python, SQL, Bash, TypeScript, JavaScript, R
- **Machine Learning**: PyTorch, unsloth, HuggingFace, scikit-learn, Inspect AI, harbor, LangGraph, langfuse
- **Web and Product Engineering**: React, FastAPI, Astro, Express.js, Flask, TailwindCSS
- **Tools and DevOps**: Git, Docker, Vercel, Railway, LaTeX, Zotero
- **Languages**: Vietnamese (native), English (fluent/C1), Mandarin Chinese (lower-intermediate/B1/HSK 4)

Certificates

- **Self-study**: Technical AI Alignment (ARENA, 2025)
- **Natural Language Specialization**, deeplearning.ai (coursera.org/verify/specialization/3FJ3W7QJX8GK) Nov 2023
- **Machine Learning Specialization**, deeplearning.ai (coursera.org/verify/specialization/G9898XKB9EAV) Jun 2022

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